Research methods



Plan for today

(1) Reminder: Cluster training
(2) Assessment: Sourcing and systematising literature
(3) LaTeX
(4) Assessment: Literature review
(5) Citation and references
(6) Questions about your projects answered

Reminder: Cluster training

MSB has a high-performance computing cluster. If your Honours project will be computationally intensive, you'll probably need to use the cluster.

To use the cluster,

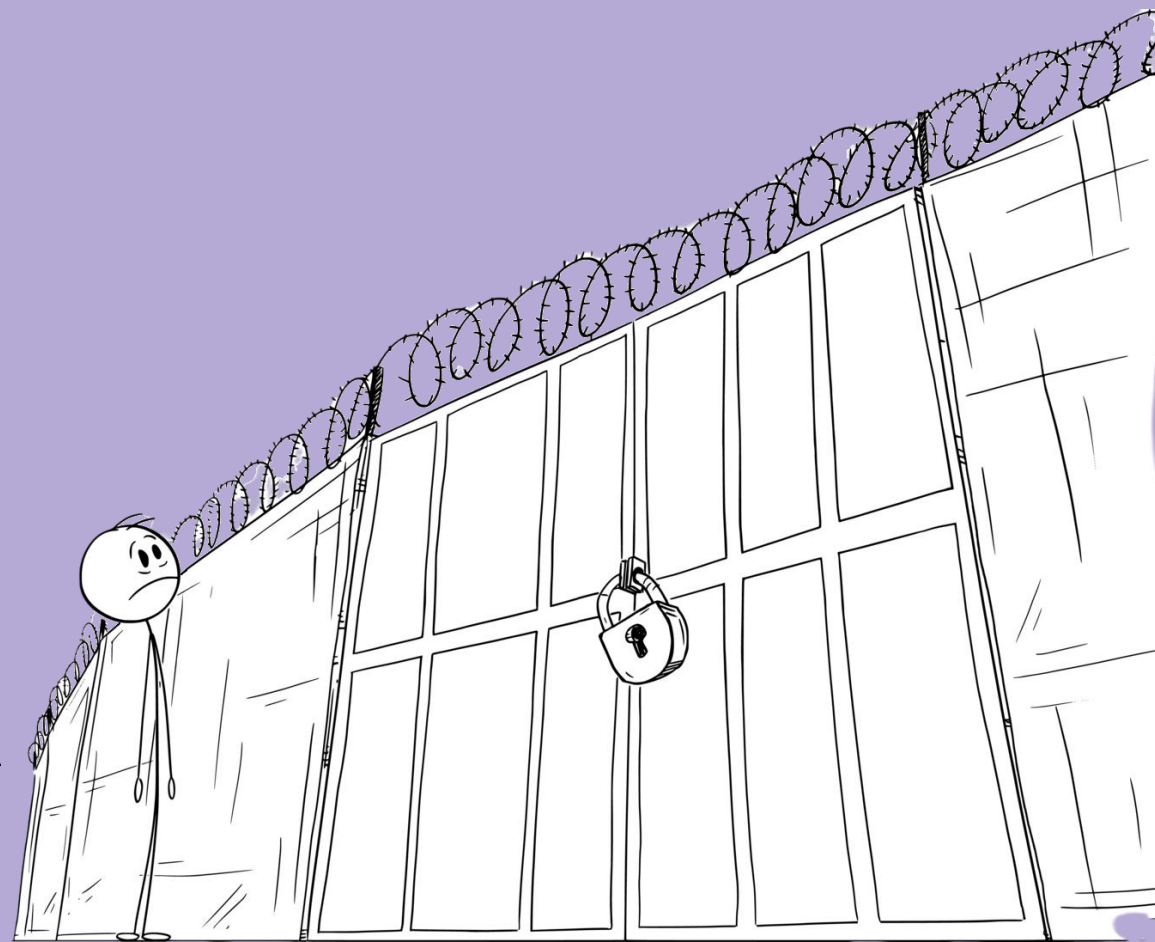
you'll need to complete a set of tasks on Moodle.

To complete the set of tasks on Moodle,

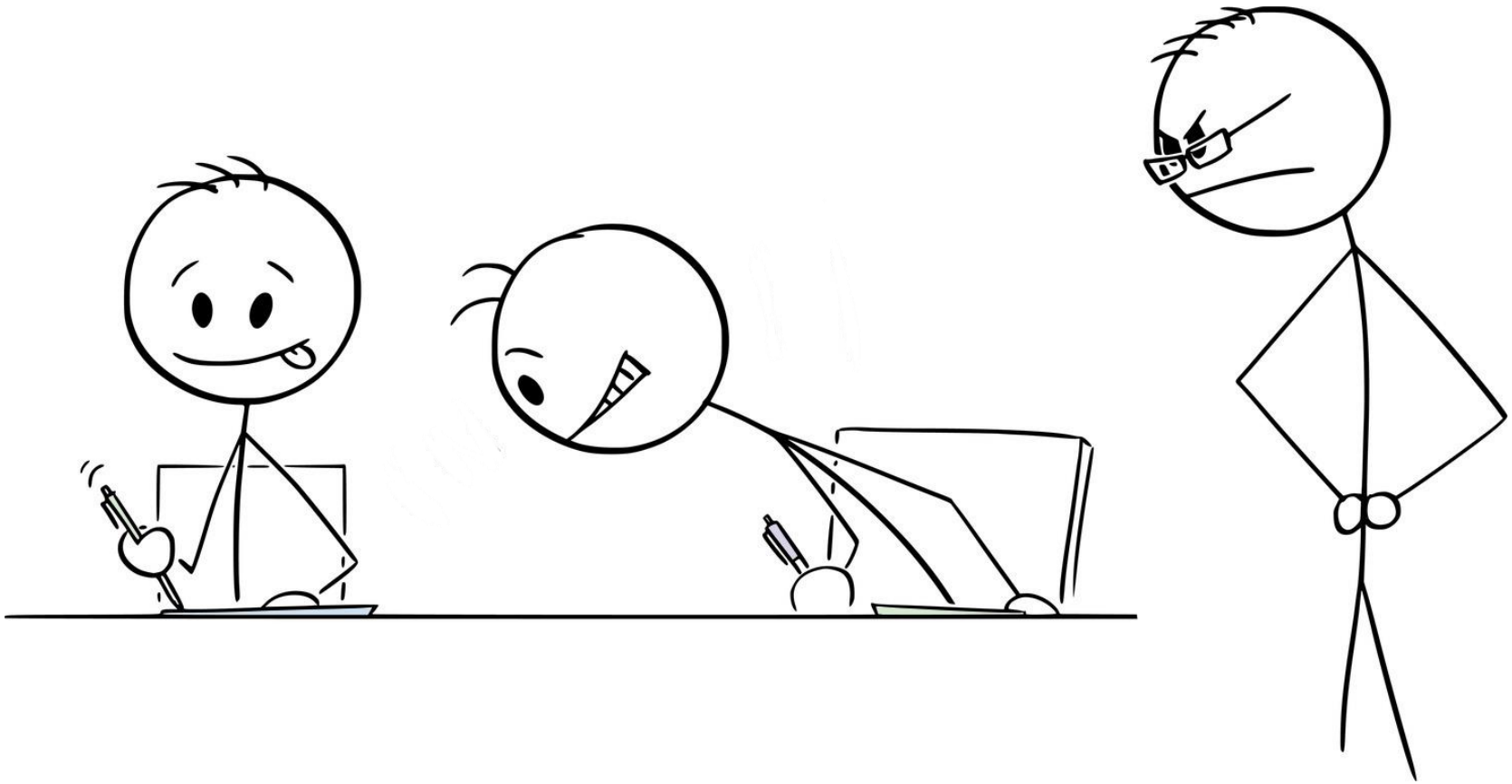
you'll probably need to attend cluster training.

To attend cluster training,

you'll need to complete the Google Form via the link on the IRM/RMCP course site.



Assessment: Sourcing and systematising literature



Assessment: Sourcing and systematising literature

The purpose of this assessment is for you to begin sourcing, reading, and systematising literature that is relevant to your project.

The format of this assessment will be chosen by your supervisor(s). Your supervisor(s) could choose for you to present the literature as an annotated bibliography, for you to present the literature using slides during one of your meetings, or for you to present it in some other way.

Assessment: Sourcing and systematising literature

The due date of the assessment is Sunday 29 March 23:59.

Assessment: Sourcing and systematising literature

For this assessment, you need to

- source any references provided by your supervisor(s),
- ask your supervisor(s) how many further references you should identify and source,
- identify and source those further references,
- read and systematise the references that you've sourced,
- ask your supervisor(s) about the format that your assessment should take (e.g. an annotated bibliography, an oral presentation, etc.)
- prepare your assessment in the relevant format,
- make sure that your assessment is submitted or completed by the due date.

Assessment: Sourcing and systematising literature

(discussion of resources on Moodle course site)

LaTeX



LaTeX

What is LaTeX?

LaTeX is a document compiling system that is widely used in academic research and publication, especially in the mathematical sciences.



LaTeX

Why should I use LaTeX?

There are at least three good reasons to use LaTeX.

(1) It is easy to include mathematical formulas and other technical content in your document.

(2) It is easy to include citations and a list of references in your document.

(3) It is required for your assessments for this course.



LaTeX

Why should I not use LaTeX?

There is at least one good reason not to use LaTeX.

(1) It takes some time to learn how to use it at the beginning.*



*This is a warning and not a justification for not using LaTeX for your assessments for this course.

LaTeX

How do I use LaTeX?

There are a lot of different packages that you can install to use LaTeX. For this course, it's recommended that you use Overleaf, which can be used through a browser or downloaded as an app.

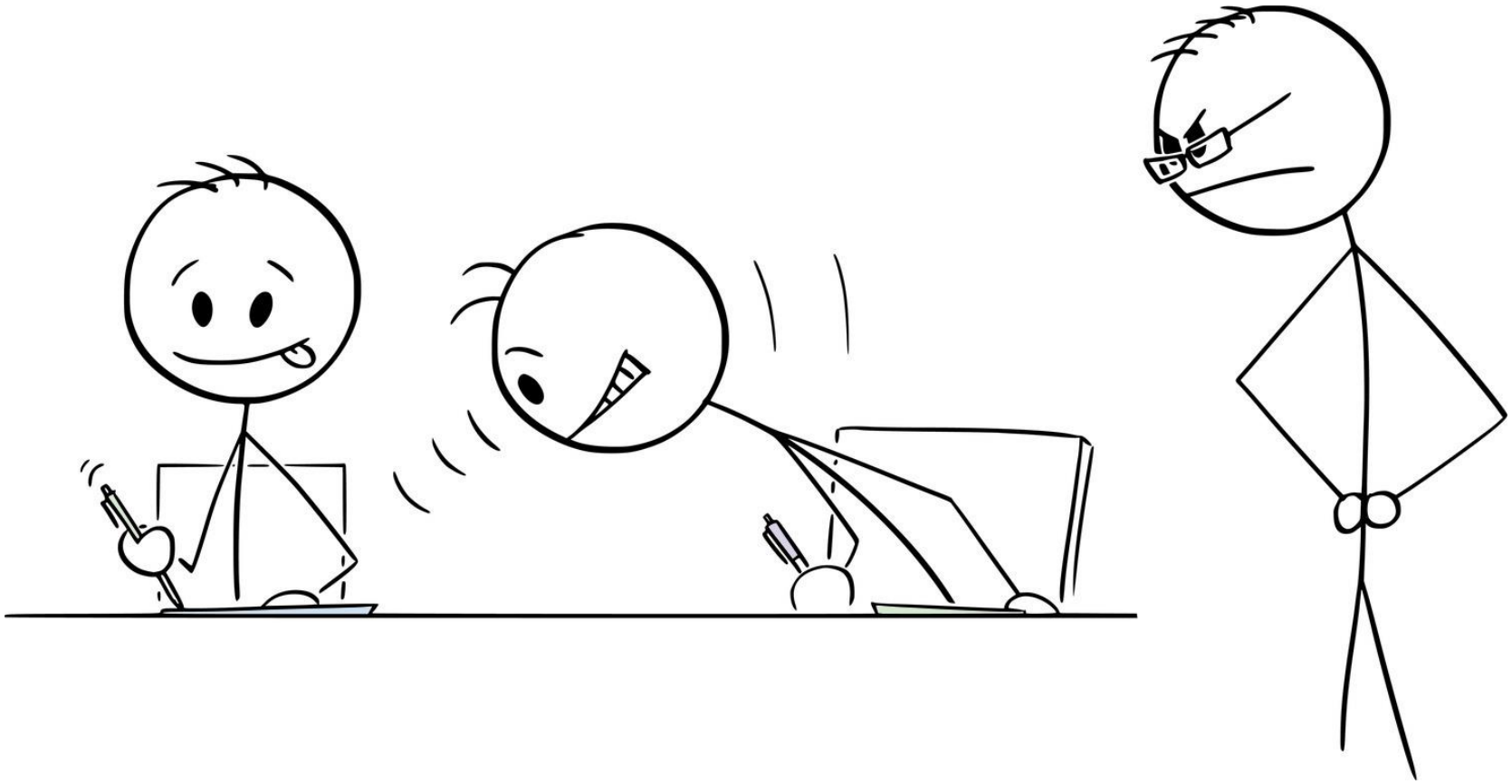


LaTeX

(demonstration of Overleaf on Google Chrome)



Assessment: Literature review



Assessment: Literature review

The purpose of this assessment is for you to show that you're familiar with the research that's relevant to your project and already been done, and that you understand how it relates to and motivates your project. The format of this assessment is a literature review. This review will form part of your research proposal.

Assessment: Literature review

The due date of the assessment is Sunday 19 April 23:59.

Assessment: Literature review

(discussion of guidelines and resources on Moodle course site)

Citation and references



Citation and references

What is citation?

When you mention something that has been published somewhere else already, a citation is a label that indicates this prior source.



Citation and references

What is a list of references?

If you have citations in your document, the list of references is a list of the full details of the publications. It appears at the end of your document.



Citation and references

(demonstration of citations and references on Overleaf)



Questions about your projects answered

